



SUJET STATAPP 320 - 2026-2027

Sujet proposé par : Präg Patrick - patrick.prag@ensae.fr
Organisme : CREST
Catégorie : Sociologie Quantitative
Sujet :
Gender Identity Inequalities in Health. Analysis of the European Social Survey

Description du sujet :

Men and women differ in their health and wellbeing. On the one hand, women live longer than men on average. On the other hand, women are more likely to suffer from illness and depression than men. Solving this puzzle has inspired a lot of research over the last decades. Generally, sex (a biological categorization, typically assigned at birth) and gender (a person's own social and psychological sense of identity) have been conflated in the existing research, and men and women have been considered to be completely distinct categories. This StatApp asks: Can we get new insights into gender inequalities in health when we take into account people's own gender identities?

A recent survey, the European Social Survey 2023?24 has collected data in 31 European countries, asked respondents not just about their sex, but also about their gender identities. In addition, it asked participants about their health status, including detailed questions about health behaviors such as drinking alcohol and exercise, health care use, and depression.

The fact that the data stem from many European countries allows us to analyze whether the relationship between gender identity and health varies across countries. This is informative, because if the relationship between gender identity and health is the same in every single country, we can conclude that any gender identity effects on health are an individual-based phenomenon; if we find variation, we can assume that the societal context shapes gender identity effects on health.

For the analysis of country differences, we will make use of random-effects models. While random-effects models are often neglected in econometrics courses (because, no one can deny it, fixed-effects models have important features and can be easier to understand), in certain situations such as country comparisons, random effects models (also known as multi-level models) come in quite handy. For instance, random effects models allow analyzing the overall country effect or allow analyzing cross-level interactions.

Statistical software will be Stata or R, depending on the students' preferences.

At the end of this project, students will have:

- An excellent understanding of multilevel models; a flexible technique that is extremely useful for analyzing clustered data, such as survey respondents clustered in countries, citizens clustered in neighborhoods, or students clustered in classrooms
- An excellent understanding of the European Social Survey, the most important European sample survey of attitudes, values, and behaviors. The ESS is an incredibly useful and versatile source of data, and having an understanding of ESS data is an important asset for answering all sorts of research questions about Europeans' attitudes, values, and behaviors, as well as social change.

Données du sujet :

The European Social Survey (ESS) is a repeated, cross-sectional survey that since 2002 collects data on the attitudes,

values, and behaviors of Europeans. Data are collected every two years and are publicly available. In every wave, 20?35 European countries participate, each contributing a nationally representative sample of 1,000?3,000 respondents. ESS data have been analyzed in thousands of academic publications so far and are an invaluable source of information about European societies. Data and exhaustive information can be found on the ESS website: <https://www.europeansocialsurvey.org/>

Modèles envisagés du sujet :

Random-effects (multilevel) models to analyze cross-country variation, including overall country effects and cross-level interactions. Statistical software: Stata or R, depending on student preference.

Bibliographie du sujet :

Banducci, Susan et al. 2020. Gender in Contemporary Europe. Rethinking Equality and the Backlash. <https://www.europeansocialsurvey.org/sites/default/files/2023-06/ESS11-gender-in-contemporary-europe.pdf>. This document describes the gender identity questions included in the most recent ESS wave.

Eikemo, Terje Andreas et al. 2020. Social Inequalities in Health and Their Determinants. <https://www.europeansocialsurvey.org/sites/default/files/2023-06/ESS11-%20Social%20Inequalities%20in%20Health%20and%20their%20Determinants.pdf>. This document describes the health questions included in the most recent ESS wave.

Robson, Karen, and David Pevalin. 2016. Multilevel Modeling in Plain Language. Sage. This is an excellent book that explains random-effects/multilevel modeling without detail, with Stata code available in the book and R code available on the book's website.

Gelman, Andrew, and Jennifer Hill. 2007. Data Analysis Using Regression and Multilevel/Hierarchical Models. Cambridge University Press. doi: <https://doi.org/10.1017/CBO9780511790942>. This is an excellent book that explains random-effects/multilevel modeling in great detail, with R code available.

Notation du sujet :

Commentaires :